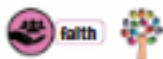


9. The Boy Who Found Grain



Warm-up

Look at the picture. What are the children doing here? Do you help your friends? Tell your class how. Think of other ways in which you can help people around you and discuss in class.



CT

COM

SR



helpfulness



This Indian folklore is popular with the Lepcha tribe of Sikkim.

One day a brave young Lepcha was hunting in a remote forest when he came upon a stream. Floating down the stream was the branch of a tree. Instead of leaves it had beautiful blue-green needles, and the bark looked as though it was made of gold. The young man knew that there was no such tree growing in the valley. He thought that the branch must have come from Mayel and that it further meant that the tree lay somewhere upstream.

upstream

towards the origin of the river





Leaving his bag of game on the forest floor and forgetting all about hunting, the young Lepcha began to climb up the mountain. He followed the path of the stream. So excited was he that he climbed for days and days but never got tired. In time he crossed the forest and a range of snow-covered mountains. After several more days he came to an open space at the heart of which lay a lake. Around the lake the young Lepcha saw a whole lot of white feathers and wondered to which birds they belonged. He pressed on and then, at long last, he reached a lush green valley surrounded by tall mountains. This was Mayel, the home of the Lepchas' ancestors.

The sun was already setting when the young man reached the first house in the valley. He knocked at the stout wooden door and an old woman opened it. She took him in and offered him a rug to sit on. Then she brought him some hot water to wash his feet. Later, when he was rested, she served a simple but satisfying meal of roasted grain, fruit and milk. The old woman was soon joined by an old man and the young Lepcha learnt that the old couple lived all by themselves in that house and that they were childless.

lush

covered in green, healthy plants, grass, and trees



The young Lepcha lay down on the rug and was soon fast asleep. He slept soundly till the sun rose again behind the mountain peaks. And then he was awakened by the sound of children at play. He got out of bed to find a little boy and girl running about the house. He thought they were the neighbours' children and that the old people had probably gone to work in the fields. But when he asked the children who they were, they laughed merrily and answered that they were the old couple. The young man was **thoroughly** confused. The children informed him that this was how their world worked. In the morning they became children. By midday they grew up into adults. In the evening they were old. But by the following morning they were children again. In this way they lived on forever.

The young Lepcha spent seven very happy days in the valley. He roamed around, enjoying the beautiful scenery. He saw a whole forest of trees with blue-green needles and golden barks. And morning and evening he saw large flocks of white birds flying across the sky. At the end of seven days, the old woman told the young Lepcha that he must return to his world as no ordinary human was allowed to live in Mayel.

thoroughly completely





The old woman gave him the seeds of several different kinds of grain as a gift. She said that if those seeds were sown in the village, his people would always have plenty to eat. But they would have to be sown at a proper time. The young man asked them how he would know when the great time was. Just then a flock of white birds flew past them. The old woman smiled. She said that they would send a flock of white birds as a signal for the **apt** time.

The Lepchas believe that this is how they came to have food grains. To this day when they see flocks of white birds, they know it is time for them to sow their crops. Once the sowing is over, they begin to pray to their ancestors in Mayel to send them a good harvest.

apt

suitable or appropriate



Reading

(reading for main ideas)

A. Choose the right options to answer these questions. Revise the lesson before checking your answers.

1. What did the young Lepcha find floating down the stream?
 - a. a golden branch with blue-green needles
 - b. a blue branch with green needles
 - c. a green branch with gold needles
 - d. a brown branch with green needles
2. What did the Lepcha find around the lake?
 - a. He saw a whole lot of white birds.
 - b. He saw a whole lot of white petals.
 - c. He saw a whole lot of white feathers.
 - d. He saw a whole lot of grey feathers.
3. What did the Lepcha learn about the old couple?
 - a. They had a son and a daughter.
 - b. They were childless.
 - c. They had adopted their neighbour's children.
 - d. Their children were living in the city.



- 
4. What did the old woman give the Lepcha as a gift?
- several different kinds of seeds
 - several different kinds of flowers
 - several different kinds of feathers
 - several different kinds of grains



B. State whether these sentences are true (T) or false (F). Work in pairs. Share your answers with your peer. Go through the chapter once again before checking each other's answers. 

- The young Lepcha was hunting in the forest. _____
- The old woman did not open the door. _____
- The old man asked the Lepcha to leave their hut. _____
- The young Lepcha stayed in Mayel for seven days. _____
- The Lepchas pray to their ancestors in Mayel for a good harvest. _____

(reading for inference; HOTS)

C. Read these sentences from the story and answer the questions that follow. Check your answers. 

- ...He pressed on and then, at long last, he reached a lush green valley surrounded by tall mountains.*
 - Who is 'he'?
 - Where had he reached? Describe the place.
- He got out of bed to find a little boy and girl running about the house.*
 - Who is 'he'?
 - Who were the children?
 - What interesting fact did he learn about the children?

D. Discuss in class.    **CT** **faith**

(value-based question)

Once the sowing is over, they begin to pray to their ancestors in Mayel to send them a good harvest.

Why do you think the Lepchas pray to their ancestors?





Using Grammar

(adverbs of manner)

You have learnt that adverbs are words that tell us more about the verb.

Adverbs of manner tell us how an action is done.

He slept **soundly** till the sun rose again behind the mountain peaks.

Here the adverb, **soundly**, tells you how the young Lepcha slept.

- 3 A. Complete the sentences with suitable adverbs of manner from the box. Work in pairs and find out the verbs that each adverb modifies. Check your answers with your teacher.**

merrily thoroughly happily earnestly graciously

1. The young Lepcha roamed around the valley _____.
2. The children's answer left the young man _____ confused.
3. The old woman smiled at him _____.
4. The Lepchas pray _____ to their ancestors for a good harvest.
5. The children played around the hut _____.

(adverbs of time)

Adverbs of time tell us when the action is done.

One day a brave young Lepcha was hunting in a remote forest...

Here the adverb phrase, **one day**, tells us when or at what time the Lepcha was hunting.

- 3 B. Identify the adverbs of time in these sentences. Discuss your answers with your teacher.**

1. The boys said they would study later as they had other things to do.
2. I want to play today while the sun is shining.
3. Please bring me the medicine now.
4. I will attend the ceremony tomorrow.
5. I tried to call you yesterday.





Using Words

(words commonly confused)

In English, we may have doubts regarding the use of certain words which sound similar. Let us look at some examples.

- pour – pore
- their – there



A. Circle the right options to answer these questions. Check your answers and find out what these pairs of words are called.



- | | |
|--|-------------|
| 1. Which is a part of your body? | ear, year |
| 2. Which is a collection of animals? | herd, heard |
| 3. Which is a part of your foot? | heel, heal |
| 4. Which is a colour? | blew, blue |
| 5. Which word refers to travel on water? | sail, sale |

(collocations)

Read these sentences.

- I don't want to **make a choice**.
- He did not like to **do any work**.

The highlighted phrases are **collocations**. Certain words sound right when combined together.

- make ✓ do × a choice
- make × do ✓ work



B. Choose the right options to complete these sentences. Check your answers.



- John is really (making/doing) an effort to improve his maths this year.
- We'll (make/do) some work on our project and then we'll go to the movies.
- Rahila is very good at (making/doing) friends.
- They've (made/did) a mistake in our bill.
- He likes to (make/do) his homework regularly.



Spelling

(double consonants)

All words have syllables. A **syllable** is the part of a word that makes one sound. Some words, like 'tug', have one syllable, and some words, like



'hap-pen', have two syllables. Also, there are words, like 'hap-pen-ing', that have more than two syllables.

Work in pairs and divide these words into two syllables. Then learn how to spell them. Take help from your teacher.  **TC**

rabbit
happen

winner
kitten

tunnel
puppet

butter
pepper

lesson
supper



Assessment of Speaking and Listening



Listening

(listening for details)



Listen to this poem and fill in the blanks. Check your answers.



Girls and boys, come out to play,
The _____ doth shine as bright as day;
Leave your _____, and leave your sleep,
And come with your _____ into the street.
Come with a _____, come with a call,
Come with a _____ or not at all.
Up the ladder and _____ the wall,
A halfpenny _____ will serve us all.
You find milk, and I'll find _____,
And we'll have a _____ in half an hour.



Pronunciation

(revision: diphthong in ear with familiar consonant sounds)



Remember the sounds you practised. Say these words aloud and revise the sounds.  

peer

teardrop

dear

gear

fear

deer

Speaking

(inviting and responding to invitations)

This is what the old woman might have said when the young man knocked on her door.

You have travelled a long way. You must be tired. Would you like to come inside?

Here are some more expressions we can use.

For inviting people	Accepting the invitation	Refusing the invitation
Would you like to come...?	Thanks, I'd love to...	I'm afraid I can't. I'm...
Why don't you come and join us?	Yes, I'd like to...	I'm sorry but I can't. I'm...

A. Work in pairs. Role play these situations. Respond as indicated.

1. Your friend invites you to his house for a birthday party.
You accept the invitation.
2. You invite your friend to come over to your house to watch a film. He/She refuses as he/she has piano lessons.

(speaking on a topic)

B. Talk about your food habits.

1. For breakfast, I sometimes have...
2. For lunch, I never have...
3. In the evening, I usually drink...
4. My favourite vegetable is...
5. My favourite fruit is...
6. I really dislike (a type of food/drink)...





Writing

(writing a story)

Look at these pictures. They show a story of how a lion and a mouse became friends. Colour the pictures and write the story using the hints.  **C** 



lion sleeping in forest—disturbed by mouse playing on his mane—lion angry and wants to eat the mouse—mouse begs for his life and promises to help the lion in times of trouble—later, lion caught in hunter's net—mouse rescues lion by cutting through the net with sharp teeth—lion thankful to mouse—lion and mouse friends for life



Life Skills Activity

(self-awareness; coping with emotions)

How do you feel today? Choose one or more words from the ones in the table. Discuss why you are feeling like that.  **COM**

tired
angry

disappointed
proud

happy
surprised

content
hopeful